



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Who is Isabelle Richardson?



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Describe your family. How many uncles, aunts, and cousins do you have?
- Do they have different personalities? What are they like?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about family life and personal qualities.
- I can ask questions about how people are.
- I can write about future action, plans and intentions.





Let's Explore!

Isabelle talks about her family. How is everyone different?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I'm going to tell you about my family. My name is Isabelle Richardson. I'm twenty-five years old and from San Diego, California. I consider myself to be a realist. I take things at face value and am honest with my feelings. One of my weaknesses is that I am not very flexible. When situations change unexpectedly, it is a real challenge for me. My immediate family includes two older brothers who are at a prestigious university, Sean and Luca. How clever are they to be at a famous university? They are arriving from New York tonight for the holidays.

I come from a blended family; this is my father's second marriage. He had two children with his first wife. They are my half-sisters, Camilla and Roseanne. We are always excited to see each other. However, we all have different personalities. Camilla tends to be a little too impulsive while Roseanne is quick-tempered.

Christmas gatherings are always an experience! This year, we will be heading to the snow!

How impatient is Roseanne going to be on the slopes? How crazy are we?



Let's Practice!

Can you ask rhetorical questions?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Put each word in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. famous / to / university? / at / clever / be / How / they / a / are

2. to / is / be / the /Roseanne / impatient / slopes? / going / How / on

3. are / How / we?/ crazy



Let's Practice!

What is your personality type?

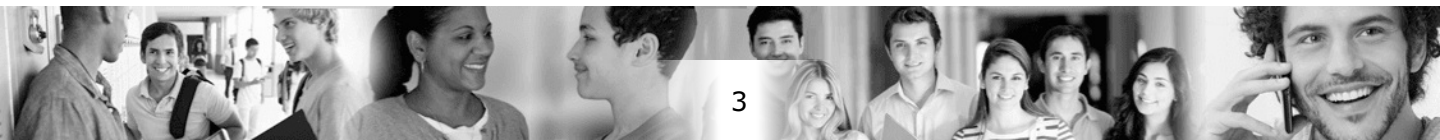
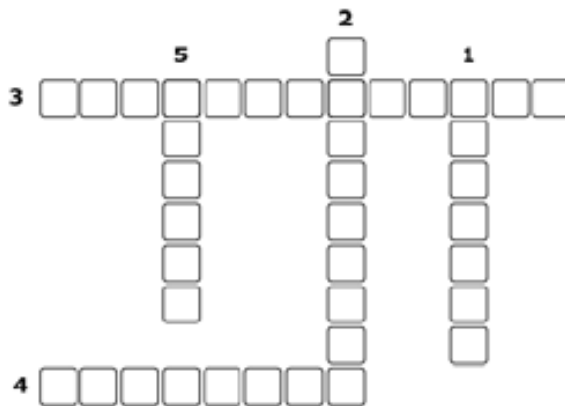
Instructions: Complete the crossword. Read the clue and identify the word that describes a personal quality.

Down

1. I consider myself to be a realist.
2. Camila tends to be a little bit impulsive.
5. How clever are they?

Across

3. Rosanne is quick-tempered.
4. I am not very flexible.





Extension Activity

How much do you know about others?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview a partner or friend about their family. Do they have a small family? Large, extended family? Blended family?
- Ask your partner to describe their personalities.
- Write a 75-100 word paragraph about their family.
- Read the paragraph aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview a friend or partner about their family.

☐ ☐

I describe people's personalities.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about a family.

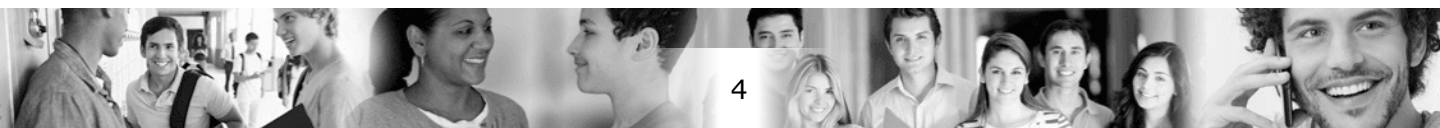
☐ ☐

I read my paragraph about a family aloud.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **unexpectedly** (adverb): not expected or planned
e.g. One of my weaknesses is that I am not very flexible. When situations change unexpectedly, it is a real challenge for me.
- **realist** (noun): a person who accepts and deals with things as they really are
e.g. I consider myself to be a realist.
- **face value** (expression): to accept someone or something just as it appears
e.g. I take things at face value
- **flexible** (adjective): willing to change or to try different things
e.g. One of my weaknesses is that I am not very flexible.
- **immediate family** (noun): close family members including brothers, sisters, and parents
e.g. My immediate family includes two older brothers.
- **blended family** (noun): a family consisting of a couple and their children from this and all previous relationships
e.g. I come from a blended family; this is my father's second marriage.
- **half-sister** (noun): a sister with whom one has only one parent in common
e.g. They are my half-sisters, Camilla and Roseanne.
- **impulsive** (adjective): acting or done without much thought
e.g. Camilla tends to be a little too impulsive.
- **slopes** (noun): hills for skiing
e.g. How impatient is Roseanne going to be on the slopes?
- **quick-tempered** (adjective): easily made angry
e.g. Roseanne is quick-tempered.





Learning Points

Writing about Family

When you are writing about your family, there are a number of items to include.

First: Introduce yourself. Include your name, age and where you are from.

Second: Include the rest of your family members (your immediate family and extended family. Sometimes a person can have a blended family).

Family Members	Example
Immediate family	<i>mother, father, sister, brother</i>
Extended family	<i>aunt, uncle, cousin</i>
Blended family	<i>half-sisters, half-brothers</i>

Examples:

- *I have two half-sisters. This is my father's second marriage.*
- *I have a large extended family.*





Learning Points

Rhetorical Questions in Writing

Rhetorical questions are questions that you don't answer. You ask rhetorical questions in order to make a point about a situation or to point out something.

Types of Rhetorical Questions	Example
Big life questions	<i>Aren't we just tiny pieces in a big picture?</i>
Questions that draw attention to something	<i>Do you know what time it is? - meaning it's late</i>
Questions to express a bad mood	<i>What's the point in trying?</i>
Questions that point to a positive	<i>Didn't I help you on your last exam?</i>

You can use the structure **How + adjective/adverb** to ask rhetorical questions. This way, you can ask a question that gets people to think about what you are writing about.

Examples:

- *How much time does it take to become successful?*
- *How much do you really know about your family members?*
- *How well do you really know yourself?*
- *How close are you really to your family?*
- *How crazy are we?*

